



Theoretical perspectives

'End of audience' theories – Clay Shirky

Shirky argues that digital technologies have had a profound effect on the relationship between media and audience members, who are no longer passively accepting their message. THIRRD actively invites audiences to get involved, participate and interact. They do not just invite you to speak back but also submit ideas for submissions, attend events and join in, or go and work for the magazine. THIRRD is a hub for dynamic interaction, a conversation about culture that allows us to discuss things through another lens.

Cultivation theory – George Gerbner

Gerbner argues that exposure to the same repeated patterns of representation reinforce the values of the dominant ideology and influence the way people think. THIRRD's intention is to question that perspective, to foreground the underrepresented and look at things through a different lens. You could argue that by thinking about the issues raised by the magazine and engaging with its content, audiences could become more aware of inequalities in our society. For example, they may become more attuned to the social and cultural impact of the issues surrounding diversity and inclusivity in mainstream fashion magazines and their very narrow definitions of what is perceived as beautiful or desirable.